Assignment: Target Company Research

DeepThought — Business Analytics Internship

About DeepThought

DeepThought is a B2B company that helps organizations become better-run through structured execution. We do this through two things:

1. Execution consulting — we place operating Fellows inside client organizations who work alongside the founder's team to structure daily operations, build accountability systems, and diagnose execution gaps. Think of it as McKinsey-grade diagnosis at MSME-affordable pricing, delivered continuously (not as a one-time project).

2. PDGMS — an AI-powered SaaS platform that structures daily work so that leadership gets diagnostic data as a byproduct. Not a project management tool. An operating system for the organization.

Our clients are typically Rs.50Cr–Rs.500Cr revenue organizations with a capable founder who wants to build internal capability — not outsource it. These companies are growing, investing in R&D or capacity, and are open to structured ways of operating. We call this profile a Federer company.

The Federer Company — Who We're Looking For

Our ideal client sits in a specific quadrant:

	Wants to build in-house	Wants to outsource
Risk-taking / growth mode	Federer (target)	Not a fit
Wealth-preservation mode	Not a fit	Not a fit

Federer = growth mindset + in-house capability building.

These are founders who are investing in new facilities, hiring talent, pursuing certifications, expanding into new markets — not sitting on existing revenue. They want to build their organization's muscles, not hand work to a vendor.

We target differentiated organizations — companies making differentiated, technical products or delivering specialized services (not bulk commodities or generic offerings). The decision-maker is typically someone who values structured operations and has demonstrated systems thinking — whether that comes from a scientific background, engineering pedigree, or years of building operational infrastructure.

About This Role

This is a Business Analytics role at DeepThought. Your job will involve:

- Identifying and researching companies that fit the Federer profile
- Building targeted outreach lists for specific cities and industry segments

- Crafting personalized first-touch messages that demonstrate we understand what the company actually does

- Supporting the sales pipeline from initial research through to first conversation

This assignment simulates the core research task of the role. The output you produce — if it's good — will feed directly into our active prospect pipeline. This is real work, not a hypothetical exercise.

Important: Read This Before Starting

> We use AI tools extensively at DeepThought — Claude, Gemini, GitHub Copilot, and others. We encourage you to use them too. But there is a difference between using AI as a thinking partner and copy-pasting AI output without applying your mind.
>
> Most candidates we receive paste a prompt into ChatGPT, copy the output, and submit it as their work. The result is generic, unverified, and indistinguishable from every other submission. These get rejected within 30 seconds.
>
> This is why Part B of this assignment requires a hand-drawn diagram submitted via Internshala chat. A hand-drawn plan forces you to think through the logic yourself, make choices about what matters, and structure your thinking visually — things that copy-paste cannot fake. It is the single fastest way for our recruiters to separate candidates who actually thought about the problem from those who didn't.
>
> If you skip the hand-drawn diagram, or send a digitally generated diagram instead, your application will not be reviewed. We mean this literally. The diagram is how we filter 90% of applications before spending quality time on the remaining 10%.

The Assignment Has Two Parts

Part	What	Submit Where
Part A	Research output: CSV + methodology + code	Upload to GitHub or Google Drive. Share the link on Internshala.
Part B	Sourcing strategy + scale-up proposal	Send directly in the Internshala chat window. Must include a hand-drawn diagram.

PART A: Find 25 Target Companies

Submit: GitHub repo or Google Drive folder. Share link on Internshala.

Expect a ~30% yield. From our own research, roughly 7 out of 10 companies you investigate will turn out to be a poor fit — wrong segment, too big, too small, PE-owned, not actually a producer, stale. You will likely need to research 75-100 companies to find 25 that genuinely pass. Plan your time accordingly.

Pick one city from this list (or propose another Indian hub with justification):

- Hyderabad
- Pune
- Ahmedabad
- Chennai
- Coimbatore
- Vadodara
- Bengaluru
- Indore
- Surat
- Ludhiana
- Kolhapur

City means operational presence, not just registered office. If a company's founder, R&D, or primary operations are in your chosen city but their registered office is elsewhere, that counts. If they only have a sales office in your city but everything real happens elsewhere, that doesn't count. Use your judgment and state your reasoning.

Pick one or two industry segments from the list below:

Segment Options

Basket A — Specialty Manufacturing (strongest fit)

- Specialty biotech (probiotics, enzymes, recombinant proteins, fermentation services)
- Specialty diagnostics & life-science tools (diagnostic kits, antibodies, reagents, genomics tools)
- Custom synthesis & specialty chemicals (pharma intermediates, agrochem intermediates, electronic chemicals, catalysts)
- Performance chemicals (polymer additives, specialty surfactants, coatings & resins, water treatment chemicals)

Basket B — Adjacent Specialty

- Complex APIs & regulated pharma (HPAPIs, peptide APIs, sterile injectables — NOT generic/bulk pharma)
- Medical devices (IVD platforms, implants, surgical instruments, wearables)
- Hybrid seeds & specialty agri-inputs (hybrid seeds, biopesticides, biofertilizers, micro-irrigation)
- Specialty food & nutraceutical ingredients (plant proteins, botanical extracts, oleoresins, functional ingredients)
- Industrial sensors & instrumentation (process sensors, analyzers, vision systems, IoT monitoring)
- Animal health & veterinary biologics (veterinary vaccines, feed additives, aquaculture inputs)

Basket C — Operator-Led Specialty

- Technical textiles & specialty yarns (functional yarns, performance fabrics, composite textiles — NOT commodity weaving)
- Precision auto components & engineering (CNC machining, aerospace-grade components, die-casting, tooling — NOT bulk stamping)
- Specialty food processing (custom formulations, contract manufacturing for FMCG, clean-label ingredients)
- Designer / artisanal manufacturing (luxury craft, custom manufacturing with brand positioning — NOT mass commodity production)

Eligibility Gates

Before scoring, every company must pass two eligibility gates. If either gate fails, do not score — move on.

Gate	Requirement	Why It's a Gate
E1: Producer	Produces a product or delivers a specialized service in-house. Has its own facility, plant, studio, or operational infrastructure. Not a trader, distributor, reseller, or pure intermediary.	DT works with organizations that build capability in-house. Traders and distributors don't have the operational infrastructure where our work applies.
E2: Accessible	Operational presence that DT can reach. Currently this means India — HQ or primary operations in India.	DT's Fellows work on-site. Remote-only companies with no physical operational presence don't fit the model today.

Watch out for service companies that look like producers — CROs (contract research organizations), testing labs, analytical service providers, and clinical trial managers operate in the same industries (biotech, pharma, chemicals) but sell services, not products. Always verify the company actually makes something or delivers a proprietary service.

Scoring Criteria — The Federer Score (out of 100)

Evaluate each company against these 6 criteria. Not every company will score perfectly on all 6 — use your judgment.

#	Criterion	Weight	What to Look For
C3	Differentiated	20	Makes something niche or technical — not a commodity. Two types of differentiation count: (1) IP-based: patents, R&D centre, regulatory approvals (USFDA, EU-GMP, DSIR-recognized), "first/only/pioneer in India", proprietary products. (2) Capability-based: specialized equipment (German/Japanese/Swiss machines in a market of Chinese), proprietary processes, custom manufacturing competitors can't replicate, market-shaping innovation (e.g., first company to offer 500kg MOQ in an industry that demanded 10 tons). Both are real differentiation.
C4	Decision-Maker Quality	15	The founder or MD demonstrates the ability to build structured operations. Two archetypes qualify: (1) Science-founder: PhD,

IIT/NIT/BITS/IISc alumni, ex-ISRO/DRDO, engineering pedigree, technical publications. (2) Operator-founder: demonstrated systems thinking — ERP/SAP investment, structured costing models, formal planning processes, contribution-based measurement, evidence of building operational infrastructure over time. Gen-2 leaders with formal education AND operational involvement also count. |

| C5 | Growing Sector | 15 | Operating in a sector with tailwinds. Look for: PLI scheme eligibility, Make-in-India relevance, China+1 beneficiary, export markets, government support, D2C growth trends. |

| C6 | Growth Signals | 15 | Company is expanding, not stagnant. Must meet at least 2 of the 5 thresholds below. |

| C7 | Systems Maturity | 20 | Evidence that the company operates through structured systems, not just founder intuition. Look for: ERP/SAP implementation, structured costing models, MIS/dashboard usage, digital infrastructure, IT roles on LinkedIn, job postings mentioning SAP/ERP. A company that invested in operational systems already thinks structurally — they've accepted "we need process." Companies with zero systems infrastructure are significantly harder to work with. |

| C8 | Leadership Succession | 15 | Evidence of generational transition or leadership depth beyond the founder. Look for: Gen-2 formally appointed to the board (check MCA filings for appointment date), returned from external education or career before joining, taking an operational role (not just equity holding). Also: non-family professional managers hired into senior roles (COO, CFO, CTO from outside the family), independent directors on the board, multiple V4-level leaders with distinct portfolios (not one person holding every title). |

C6 — Growth Signal Thresholds

A company counts as "actively growing" if it meets at least 2 of these 5 signals:

Signal	What counts
Hiring	5+ open roles on LinkedIn or Naukri in the last 6 months
Facility	New plant, expansion, or capacity addition announced in the last 18 months
Certifications	New regulatory approval or certification obtained in the last 2 years
Website	Copyright current year or last year, active news/press section with updates
Financial	Revenue growth visible in public filings (MCA, Tofler, RoC), or new export markets entered

1 signal = moderate. 2+ signals = strong. 0 signals = weak (likely stagnant — research further before including).

Scoring — How to Rate Each Criterion

Each criterion has a weight. Score each as Weak (0), Moderate (half the weight), or Strong (full weight).

| # | Criterion | Weight | Weak (0) | Moderate (half) | Strong (full) |

|---|-----------|--------|----------|-----------------|---------------|

| C3 | Differentiated | 20 | Commodity product, no IP or capability moat | Some technical depth but no patents/approvals/specialized equipment | Patents, DSIR,

USFDA/EU-GMP, proprietary products, OR specialized equipment + custom capability + market-shaping innovation |

| C4 | Decision-Maker Quality | 15 | Non-technical promoter, no systems thinking, outsource mindset | Gen-2 with formal education, or some evidence of structured operations | Founder/MD is PhD/IIT/IISc/scientist, OR operator who built ERP/costing models/formal planning infrastructure |

| C5 | Growing Sector | 15 | Declining or stagnant sector | Stable sector, no specific tailwinds | PLI eligible, China+1, Make-in-India, export tailwinds, government push |

| C6 | Growth Signals | 15 | No visible activity in 2 years | 1 signal from threshold table | 2+ signals from threshold table |

| C7 | Systems Maturity | 20 | No evidence of ERP, digital systems, or structured processes | Some evidence (IT head on LinkedIn, mentions of software) but unclear depth | SAP/ERP confirmed, structured costing, MIS dashboards, digital infrastructure clearly in use |

| C8 | Leadership Succession | 15 | Solo founder, no gen-2, no professional managers, all titles on one person | Gen-2 exists but unclear involvement, OR one professional hire | Gen-2 formally on board with operational role, AND/OR multiple professional managers from outside, AND/OR distinct V4 portfolios across leadership |

How to interpret the score:

Score	Band	What it means
80-100	A — Strong Federer	High-priority target. Include with confidence.
60-79	B — Probable Federer	Good target. Include, note any caveats.
40-59	C — Borderline	Research further. May have a hidden disqualifier.
Below 40	D — Not ICP	Do not include. Document why in your fail list.

Auto-disqualify if:

- Primarily a trader, distributor, or importer (fails E1)
- Service company, not producer (CROs, testing labs, analytical service providers, clinical trial managers) — unless delivering a proprietary specialized service
- Generic pharma (bulk APIs, branded generics, vaccines)
- Subsidiary of a large group (e.g., a Tata or Reliance division)
- Recently acquired by a larger group (even if previously independent — acquisition changes the promoter dynamic)
- PE/VC-controlled (majority institutional ownership, not promoter-driven)
- Revenue above Rs.500Cr (too large for our segment — and check current revenue, not just last available annual report; fast-growing companies in hot sectors like defence can jump past Rs.500Cr in a single year)
- No website or single-page placeholder site
- No visible activity in the last 2 years

Worked Examples

To show you what good profiling looks like — and what a fail looks like — here are examples from our research.

Example 1: PASS — Ananth Technologies (Science-Founder Archetype)

Field	Detail
Website	ananthtech.com
Segment	Defence electronics / aerospace
What they make	Satellite systems, avionics, radar subsystems for ISRO and Indian defence
Revenue	Rs.270Cr FY24 (+30% YoY), Rs.900Cr order book
Decision-maker	Dr. Subba Rao Pavuluri (Founder, ex-ISRO), gen-2 CEO Adithya Anand
E1 Producer	PASS — in-house satellite integration, multiple facilities
E2 Accessible	PASS — Hyderabad HQ
C3 Differentiated	Strong (20) — AS9100C certified, IN-SPACe authorized as first private GSO satellite operator
C4 Decision-Maker	Strong (15) — founder is ex-ISRO scientist, gen-2 actively leading
C5 Tailwind	Strong (15) — defence indigenization, IN-SPACe policy, space sector opening
C6 Growth	Strong (15) — 30% revenue growth, Rs.900Cr order book, expanding
C7 Systems	Strong (20) — AS9100C requires rigorous quality/process systems, multiple integrated facilities
C8 Succession	Strong (15) — gen-2 CEO (Adithya Anand) formally appointed, founder transitioning
Total	100/100 — A-band
Verdict	Textbook Federer. Scientist-founder, gen-2 transition, high-growth defence/space, deep technical moat, systems maturity evidenced by AS9100C.
Personalization hook	"First private Indian company authorized for GSO satellite operations under IN-SPACe"

Example 2: PASS — Pioneer Embroideries (Operator-Founder Archetype)

Field	Detail
Website	silkolite.in, pelhakoba.com
Segment	Technical textiles / specialty yarns (Basket C)
What they make	Specialty polyester yarns — FDY, POY, DTY, ATY, functional yarns (flame retardant, recycled, anti-microbial, UV stabilized, biodegradable). German Barmag technology. 500kg MOQ in an industry that demanded 10 tons
Revenue	Rs.300-400Cr

Decision-maker	Saurabh Maheshwari (ED, CA, 21 years textiles), DNN Rao (CEO, B.Tech Textile Engineering), Vishal Sekhani (ED, CA, finance + digital + retail)
E1 Producer	PASS — own plant, German Barmag machines, full in-house production
E2 Accessible	PASS — manufacturing in Himachal Pradesh, HQ Mumbai
C3 Differentiated	Strong (20) — German Barmag technology (yield advantage over Chinese machines), pioneered 500kg MOQ, in-house master batch factory, 1,000 shades, specialty functional yarns. Capability-based differentiation
C4 Decision-Maker	Strong (15) — multiple leaders with distinct portfolios: ED built SAP contribution costing model (₹1,100/line threshold), CEO sets operational targets, second ED owns digital + retail expansion. Demonstrated systems thinking across leadership
C5 Tailwind	Moderate (8) — textiles has PLI (man-made fiber), some China+1. Not a premium tailwind sector
C6 Growth	Strong (15) — facility expansion (super-specialty machines about to order), hiring (QA team planned), financial growth target (EBITDA ₹24Cr→₹32Cr)
C7 Systems	Strong (20) — SAP S/4HANA since 2013, 7 modules active, contribution-based costing model, structured planning processes, daily SAP dashboards
C8 Succession	Moderate (8) — multiple leaders but family/founder still central. Professional CFO hired. Non-family directors on board
Total	86/100 — A-band
Verdict	Operator-led Federer. No PhD or IIT credentials, but leadership built SAP costing models, contribution thresholds, and structured expansion over 19 years. Strong systems maturity. Basket C company that scores A-band through capability moat + operational infrastructure.
Personalization hook	"Built India's first 500kg-MOQ specialty yarn operation when the industry demanded 10-ton minimums — with in-house master batch compounding to make it work"

Example 3: FAIL — Suven Pharma

Field	Detail
Segment	CDMO / pharma intermediates
Fail reason	Now Advent-owned (PE-controlled). No longer promoter-driven. Fails the Federer test — decision-making has shifted to institutional investors, not a founder building capability.

Example 4: BORDERLINE — S&D Apparel

Field	Detail
Segment	Designer / artisanal manufacturing (Basket C)
What they make	Hand-embroidered premium nightwear, designer label, D2C
Revenue	Rs.3.5Cr
E1 Producer	PASS — in-house manufacturing, 120+ craftsmen
E2 Accessible	PASS — Kolkata

| C3 Differentiated | Moderate (10) — hand embroidery, designer positioning, FDCI member. But no patents, no regulatory moat, no equipment-based advantage |

| C4 Decision-Maker | Weak (5) — founder has 40 years domain depth but no systems thinking evidence. No ERP, no structured costing, no formal planning. Gen-2 (NIFT-trained) is capable but has no formal authority |

| C5 Tailwind | Moderate (8) — D2C growth, affordable luxury segment. No PLI, no China+1 |

| C6 Growth | Moderate (8) — revenue doubled (1.5→3.5Cr), D2C expansion. But from a very small base |

| C7 Systems | Weak (0) — zero ERP, zero digital infrastructure, paper-based processes, no structured costing model. Biggest red flag in the profile |

| C8 Succession | Moderate (8) — gen-2 (Khyati) is NIFT-trained, AI-native, actively in the business. But not formally on the board, doesn't have decision authority |

| Total | 39/100 — D-band (Not ICP) |

| Verdict | Strong brand and craft capability, but zero systems maturity and no formal authority in the gen-2 leader. C7=0 is a structural disqualifier for DT's model — without operational infrastructure, there's nothing to build on. Include in fail list with reasoning. |

| Why this matters: This example shows that a company can have real differentiation (hand embroidery, 40-year legacy, FDCI membership) and a capable next-gen leader, but still fail the Federer test if there are no systems and the decision-maker with authority hasn't demonstrated systems thinking. DT needs infrastructure to work with — we improve how companies operate, which requires that structured operations exist or are being actively built. |

What to learn from these: Notice that Example 2 (Pioneer) scores A-band despite being in textiles with no PhD founder — because C7 (Systems Maturity) and C4 (operator systems thinking) carry the score. Example 4 (S&D) fails despite strong craft because C7=0 is a structural gap. The scoring rewards companies that have built operational infrastructure, regardless of whether the founder has academic credentials or IP moats.

Part A Deliverable Format

For each of the 25 companies, provide:

Field	What to Include
Company name	—
Website	—
City / Location	—
Segment	Which segment from the list above (including Basket A, B, or C)
What they make	1-2 lines — specific products, not generic category
Revenue band (estimate)	<Rs.30Cr / Rs.30-100Cr / Rs.100-300Cr / Rs.300-500Cr / >Rs.500Cr / Unknown
Decision-maker	Name, title, background (if findable)
E1: Producer	PASS / FAIL + one line evidence

| E2: Accessible | PASS / FAIL + one line evidence |

| Criterion C3-C8 scores | For each: score (Weak / Moderate / Strong) + one line of evidence |

| Overall Federer Score | Sum of C3-C8 (out of 100) + band (A/B/C/D) |

| Overall verdict | Strong fit / Fit / Borderline — with a 1-line reasoning |

| Personalization hook | One specific, true, recent detail about this company that could be used in line 1 of an outreach email |

A sample spreadsheet with profiled companies (passes and fails) is attached as a reference. Study the level of evidence detail expected — especially how fail companies are documented with clear reasoning, not just "doesn't fit."

What to upload (GitHub repo or Google Drive folder):

1. CSV / spreadsheet — the 25 companies in the format above

2. Methodology document — how you found these companies, what sources you used, what your research process looked like, and what you learned about the segment along the way

3. Code (if you used any) — scraping scripts, API calls, data processing notebooks, prompts you wrote for AI tools. If you didn't write code, that's fine — explain your manual process in the methodology document instead.

Share the GitHub/Google Drive link on Internshala.

PART B: Sourcing Strategy + Scale-Up Proposal

Submit: directly in the Internshala chat window.

This part has two questions. Answer both in the Internshala chat window.

Question 1: Sourcing Methods

How else would you find companies that match the Federer profile across India?

Think beyond Google search. We're looking for:

- Specific databases, directories, or registries you would use (name them)

- Industry events, expos, or associations that concentrate these companies

- Government or regulatory data sources that signal ICP fit

- Any creative or unconventional sourcing methods

For each method: name it, explain why it works for this ICP specifically, and note any limitations.

Question 2: The 1000-Company Proposal

If you are offered this internship, how would you build a list of 1000 ICP-qualified companies within one month?

Assume you will be provided any tool or licence you need: Claude, Gemini, GitHub Copilot, Antigravity, or any other software. You have access to AI, scraping tools, databases, and API credits. The constraint is time (one month) and quality (these must be genuinely ICP-qualified, not a bulk dump of company names).

Your proposal should cover:

- Where would you source the initial universe of companies?

- How would you automate the qualification step?

- How would you handle quality control (false positives, missing data, borderline cases)?

- What would week 1, week 2, week 3, week 4 look like?

- What's the realistic yield you expect at each stage?

Write up one clean version of this proposal and push it to GitHub (same repo as Part A, or a separate one). Share the link on Internshala.

The Hand-Drawn Diagram (MANDATORY)

> In addition to the GitHub proposal, you must send a hand-drawn diagram of your 1000-company plan directly in the Internshala chat window.

>

> Take a photo of a hand-drawn diagram that shows your plan visually — the sourcing funnel, the stages, the tools at each stage, the weekly flow, the quality checkpoints. It doesn't need to be beautiful. It needs to show that you thought through the problem yourself.

>

> This is not optional. Applications without a hand-drawn diagram in the Internshala chat will not be reviewed.

>

> Why we require this: most applicants copy-paste LLM output without applying their own thinking. A hand-drawn diagram is the fastest way for our recruiters to tell whether a candidate actually understood and structured the problem, or just forwarded an AI response. It takes 10 minutes to draw if you've genuinely thought about it. It's impossible to fake if you haven't.

Evaluation Criteria

We are evaluating:

1. Research quality — Did you find real companies with real evidence, or surface-level Google results? We will verify your claims.

2. ICP judgment — Can you tell the difference between a commodity producer and a specialty one? Between a growth company and a stagnant one? Between a promoter-driven company and an institutionally-controlled one? Between a company with real systems and one running on paper and WhatsApp?

3. Evidence discipline — Did you show your work, or just assert scores? Every criterion score needs a specific evidence point, not "seems strong."

4. Sourcing creativity — Can you think of ways to find these companies at scale, not just one at a time?

5. Scale-up thinking — Is your 1000-company proposal realistic? Does it account for yield rates, quality control, and time constraints?

6. Communication clarity — Is your output structured, concise, and easy to act on?

Logistics

- Time: You have 48 hours from receiving this assignment.
- Tools: Use whatever tools you want — AI, databases, LinkedIn, industry directories, government portals. We care about the output quality, not the method purity.
- Questions: If something is unclear, make a reasonable assumption and state it. Don't wait for clarification.

Submission Checklist

#	Item	Where
1	CSV with 25 companies (scored, with evidence)	GitHub / Google Drive → link on Internshala
2	Methodology document	Same repo/folder
3	Code, if used	Same repo/folder
4	Sourcing methods (Question 1)	Internshala chat window
5	1000-company proposal (full write-up)	GitHub → link on Internshala
6	Hand-drawn diagram of the 1000-company plan	Photo in Internshala chat window

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DeepThought | Building PDGMS — the AI Execution Workspace